

Coby Ritter

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Dear Recalc Academy Finance Accelerator Application Team,

As a freshman at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, I am excited to express my strong interest in joining the Recalc Academy Finance Accelerator. My passion for learning, teachability, and strong work ethic make me a strong candidate for the opportunity. I am drawn to the opportunity to learn from knowledge mentors, to expand my network, and work with individuals alike to help push my pursuit of investment banking.

At a young age, I loved the challenge of understanding complex concepts and how different variables interact. It began with curiosity about how cars operate and eventually moved into a deep fascination for military aviation. Growing up in a family full of engineers, I would sit wide-eyed listening to stories that my grandfather, who worked as a naval engineer, and my father, who works in traffic safety, would share. However, it was more than just aesthetics; I wanted to know how each piece of the plane interacted with each other. For example, how the F-35B Lightning II's front lift fan and rear nozzle allow it to hover, and how the B-2 Spirit's ducts cool, bury, and reshape exhaust to prevent any radar detection. This curiosity carried into every aspect of my life and was especially amplified when taking AP Macro/Micro Economics during my junior year of high school. Understanding how shifts in consumer confidence directly affect aggregate demand and GDP growth allowed me to think about the economy with that same mindset that made me so fascinated with cars and aviation. This only grew my curiosity and motivated me to look to major in business.

Additionally, years of competitive lacrosse taught me how to work under pressure, compete, and communicate effectively with a team. In BBYO (a Jewish teen led chapter planning events for members), I mentored two younger members and supported their growth as leaders, which pushed me to communicate clearly, give constructive feedback, and be someone others can rely on. Together, these experiences shaped how I work. I learn quickly, I adapt to my surroundings, and I put in the hours needed to succeed. I see these attributes mirrored in business, and more specifically in investment banking.

To continue to expand my knowledge of finance, I joined the Capital Management Club where I got hands-on experience through their stock pitch case competition where a team and I worked together to pitch GE Vernova at a bull case of 35% return from high energy demand and a diversified product pallet. As I prepare to compete in the Solo Pitch Competition this semester through CMC, I'm continuing to build my analytical and effective communication skills to be able to explain complex financial concepts clearly and accurately.

I'm particularly drawn to Recalc's combination of live technical training and a community built for students from schools without traditional on-campus recruiting pipelines. Coming from a non-target school for investment banking, that structure is exactly what I need to close the gap between where I am now and where I want to be. I am drawn to the opportunity to learn from knowledgeable mentors, expand my network, and work alongside individuals who share my drive to break into investment banking.

My drive and passion, mixed with the mentorship, network, and community Recalc offers, will push me to build the skills necessary to break into investment banking. Thank you for taking the time to review my application. I am excited to be applying to the Recalc Accelerator, and for the opportunity of an interview. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Coby Ritter